NGO SUPPORT TOOLKIT · 04

Event and Impact Report Template

Turn every event and project into a short, honest report that funders, partners and participants will actually read. The structure we use for our own reports.

Free to use and adapt **For** events, webinars, trainings and projects swkghana.org/support · October 2026

WHY REPORT AT ALL?

A published report builds trust with funders, thanks the people who took part, and records what you learned before it is forgotten. It is also the strongest thing you can attach to your next proposal.

THREE RULES

- Publish within two weeks, while it matters.
- Be honest about what went wrong.
- Publish totals only. Never names or contact details.

1 At a glance

Lead with four to six numbers a reader can take in within ten seconds.

Number	What it shows	Where it comes from
	People registered	Registration form, duplicates removed
	People who took part	Attendance list or platform count
	Share of women, or of young people	Registration form
	Places people came from	Registration form
	One outcome, such as people who said they will act	Feedback survey

2 The report, section by section

Summary — 3 short paragraphs

What happened, when and with whom. Who took part, in numbers. The one thing you most want a reader to remember, including any problems.

Why this event — 1–2 paragraphs

The need it responded to, with one piece of evidence, and who it was for.

What happened

half a page

The speakers or facilitators and their roles, what was covered, and how the session ran. Describe what actually happened, not only what was planned.

Who took part

charts and a short commentary

- Remove duplicate registrations before you count, and say how many you removed.
- Show the breakdowns that matter: age, gender, location, occupation, how people heard about you.
- Round percentages, and say that they may not add up to 100.
- Label every bar with its number, so the chart also works when printed in black and white.

In the room

3–6 photos

Only use photos of people who agreed to be photographed. Add a caption to each, saying what it shows.

Challenges and lessons

one block per lesson

For each challenge: what happened, what it cost, and two or three specific things you will do differently. Readers trust organisations that name their problems.

What's next and thank you

Your next event or step, with a link to register or get involved. Then thank facilitators, partners, volunteers and participants by name or organisation.

About the data

2–3 sentences

Where the numbers came from, what you excluded and why, and anything a reader should bear in mind.

3 Before you publish

- [ ] The numbers match everywhere: report, blog, social posts.
- [ ] No names, phone numbers or emails from your registration list.
- [ ] Everyone in the photos agreed, and children's guardians consented.
- [ ] Partners have seen how they are described.
- [ ] Published as a web page and as a PDF.
- [ ] Shared with participants, partners and funders.
- [ ] Linked from your website's reports page.
- [ ] Lessons added to the plan for your next event.

See an example: our Elevator Pitch Workshop report at swkghana.org/reports/elevator-pitch-workshop-2026 follows this structure.

Free to use and adapt for your organisation's own work. Please credit SWK Ghana when you share it. Last reviewed October 2026.